On 20 October, coinciding with the time Chinese artillery and mortars attacked in Nam Ka Chu in distant NEFA, heavy and medium mortars began a devastating barrage on all Indian positions in the Galwan Valley. Almost immediately, Hasabnis decided to abandon OP2 and pull the men into Galwan FDL. Helipad, with hardly any defences, was the first to fall. When the barrage lifted, Galwan FDL, Ration Party and OP1 all came under small arms and machine gun fire. OP1 was virtually wiped out with most occupants being killed, the wounded taken prisoner and a couple of men managing to escape.

At both Galwan FDL and Ration Party, the Chinese despite their hand-shaking proximity to the Indian positions, seemed hesitant to put in an infantry attack, hoping instead to blast out the Indians from their stone sangars. That the two battles lasted more than twenty-four hours was a tribute to the sheer doggedness of the Jat troops. At the Galwan FDL, Subedar Hoshiar Singh was inspirational—moving from bunker to bunker, he held the men together until, at 6 p.m., a mortar bomb killed him. The Jats still held on, fighting till the next morning. By 10 a.m., after more than thirty hours of intense bombardment and fighting, the last message from Galwan FDL was sent to HQ 114 Brigade, saying that the Chinese were now advancing on the Jat position. Hasabnis was wounded and thirty-six of the sixty-eight men had been killed. Again, a few managed to break contact and make a dash for the Galwan-Shyok river junction. The story at Ration Party was much the same with the fighting ending with the death of the commanding JCO.

Shortly thereafter, two Mi-4 helicopters flew over Galwan FDL and were fired at by the Chinese from their locations. The pilots reported that they had not seen any sign of activity at Galwan FDL or Ration Party. Bikram Singh now turned his attention to the Changchenmo Valley and ordered HQ 114 Brigade to pull back the remaining troops of 5 Jat from Patrol Base to the Nullah Junction. By then, Patrol Base was already under intense artillery fire. However, under cover of darkness, the platoon, under Naib Subedar Umaid Singh began to pull back, leaving a section strength party behind to cover their withdrawal and wait for the men who had gone towards Galwan FDL to lay a telephone line. The next morning, the Chinese tried to occupy the post but were met with heavy resistance. Subedar Amar Singh, commanding the post, fought till the Chinese killed him along with the last man.